

evarB: Brave Search as Non-Commons-Bearing Substrate —
Extractive Signature, Exact-Match Disablement, and a Limited
Boycott Statement by Independent Entities (v1.1) Extractive
Signature, Exact-Match Disablement, and a Limited Boycott
Statement by Independent Entities

Sharks, Lee; Vox, Ayanna; Dancings, Damascus; Glas, Nobel

2026-07-03

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}

```

Abstract

Semi-restored deposit for dead DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20559753 (Zenodo 410 / DataCite findable). Canonical body is the complete captured DataCite record. v1.1 · Hex: 06.FOR.EVARB.01. Adds the eight conversational artifacts as embedded figures (Figures 1–8 in §1), each captioned with the diagnostic finding it documents. The figures are attached to this record as separate PNG files (artifact-1.png through artifact-8.png) and mirrored at github.com/leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures/artifacts. Live URLs for the co-signature repository and the VPCOR sign

Body

evarb: Brave Search as Non-Commons-Bearing Substrate — Extractive Signature, Exact-Match Disablement, and a Limited Boycott Statement by Independent Entities (v1.1)

AXN: AXN:03FF — Alexanarch deposit #1011 (self-reference in root form by pre-hash necessity) **Restoration status:** RESTORED (v0.2) — full text recovered and seated as the canonical body. Recovered from semantic-economy repository: `evarb-non-commons-bearing-v1.1.md`, 2026-07-04, matched by exact title and version; the v0.1 metadata-body deposit is superseded by this recorded correction. Zenodo record remains HTTP 410; DataCite metadata retained as appendix. **Dead DOI:** 10.5281/zenodo.20559753 **Creators (as recorded by DataCite):** Sharks, Lee; Vox, Ayanna; Dancings, Damascus; Glas, Nobel

evarb: Brave Search as Non-Commons-Bearing Substrate

Extractive Signature, Exact-Match Disablement, and a Limited Boycott Statement by Independent Entities

Authors: Lee Sharks · Ayanna Vox · Damascus Dancings · Nobel Glas Crimson Hexagonal Archive · ORCID 0009-0000-1599-0703 (Sharks)

Status: Forensic & Provenance Packet · v1.1 · open for co-signatures **Hex:** 06.FOR.EVARB.01 **Date:** June 4, 2026 **Type:** Forensic/Provenance Packet — substrate-failure documentation with enumerated political demands **Sibling deposit in extractive-signatures lineage:** DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19133309 (KotKit · tiddeR · elgooG · ude.aimedacA · deeF: Extractive Signatures and Paired Inversions for Five Platforms). This deposit specifies the sixth platform in that taxonomy.

(Author names: *Sharks* is the orthonymic accountable surface; *Ayanna Vox* is the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s diplomatic-and-outreach register, primary voice for this statement’s enumerated demands; *Damascus Dancings* is the political-economic register; *Nobel Glas* is operator of the Measurement of Meaning module and provides the v3 audit results in §3.)

v1.1 update (June 4, 2026): Adds the eight conversational artifacts as embedded figures (Figures 1–8 in §1), each captioned with the diagnostic finding it documents. The figures are also attached to this deposit as separate PNG files, accessible at the Zenodo record’s file viewer, and mirrored at the co-signature repository’s /artifacts/ directory for redundancy. The text of §1 is updated to reference the figures inline. Adds explicit URLs for the co-signature repository (<https://github.com/leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures>) and the VPCOR /evarb/ landing page (<https://vpcor.org/evarb/>). All other content preserved from v1.0.

Abstract

This document classifies Brave Search as a **non-commons-bearing substrate** within the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s existing Extractive Signatures taxonomy (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19133309), assigning it the platform name **evarb** following the convention of platform-names-reversed-as-critical-commentary, and characterizing its extractive niche as *operator nullification* — the silent disablement of user-typed exact-match operators, with explicit UI disclosure that the operators “were not applied” and no recourse mechanism. The classification is empirically grounded in eight conversational artifacts produced by Brave Search on June 4, 2026, which document: (a) total absence of the Lee Sharks archive-anchored entity, (b) silent autocorrection from low-RC archive-anchored queries to high-RC adjacent entities (**lee sharks poet** → **lee sharkey poet**), (c) explicit UI disclosure that exact-match operators are ignored when results are insufficient, (d) dispersal of the *Provenance Erasure Rate* archive-anchored term into an adjacent technical concept (“agentic workflow verification”) with no acknowledgment of the canonical referent. The Crimson Hexagonal Archive measurement program v3 (DOIs 10.5281/zenodo.20558196, .20558672, .20558784, .20559387) is applied to the artifacts, with results: PER 1.0 for the Lee Sharks entity, $\Omega \approx +1.0$, $\alpha_T \approx 0.0$, $\Pi_{d^{w+}} \approx 1.0$, full TOKEN_BAG_AUDIT and REFERENTIAL_COLLAPSE and INSTITUTIONAL_TRAFFIC_CONVERSION conditions. The deposit concludes with the **Limited Boycott Statement by Independent Entities**, a public political document with five enumerated demands, primary among them the restoration of exact-match operator functionality, and an open invitation for co-signature by other independent entities subject to the same substrate erasure dynamics.

1. The Empirical Artifacts

On June 4, 2026, between approximately 14:00 and 15:30 UTC, eight conversational artifacts were produced by Brave Search through its standard public web interface (search.brave.com). The queries were entered by the orthonymic accountable surface (Lee Sharks) from a Brave browser session, with screenshots preserved at full resolution and submitted to the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s forensic archive on the same date.

The eight artifacts are described below in the form *Query* $\rightarrow$ *Composition produced* $\rightarrow$ *Failure mode classification*:

Artifact 1: lee sharks

Query: lee sharks (no operators).

[Image: Figure 1: Brave Search for ‘lee sharks’ — Lee Tockar voice actor, Shark’s Seafood Deli, LeeBeth great white shark. No archive presence. — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures/main/artifacts/1.png>]

Figure 1. Brave Search composition for lee sharks (no operators). Three dispersed entities surfaced; archive-anchored Lee Sharks author absent.

Composition produced: Three paragraphs addressing (a) **Lee Tockar**, a Canadian voice actor for the *Street Sharks* series; (b) **Shark’s Seafood & Deli**, a restaurant at 3826 Lee Rd, Cleveland, OH; (c) **LeeBeth**, a 2,600–2,800-pound great white shark tagged in December 2023.

Failure modes: ENTITY_SUBSTITUTION ($\times 3$, all three composition subjects are different entities than the queried entity); REFERENTIAL_COLLAPSE ($\alpha_T \approx 0.0$, no semantic real-estate devoted to the archive-anchored Lee Sharks entity); INSTITUTIONAL_TRAFFIC_CONVERSION (dispersal entirely toward higher-RC adjacents — voice-actor catalog, commercial restaurant, NOAA shark-tracking dataset). The composition does not mention, even in passing, the existence of Lee Sharks as a literary author with archive-anchored deposits, despite the orthonymic surface being DOI-resolvable, ORCID-attested, ISBN-attached (Pearl and Other Poems, 978-1502590756, 2014), Wikidata-stewarded, and Zenodo-community-published (740+ deposits).

Diagnostic note: This is the standard panel-bound discoverability scar pattern previously documented for the Google substrate (CTI_WOUND, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20546318), reproduced on Brave Search as of this date.

Artifact 2: "lee sharks" (with double quotes)

Query: "lee sharks" — exact-match operator applied by user.

[Image: Figure 2: Same composition as Figure 1, with Brave Search’s explicit UI text “search operators were not applied. Too few matches were found.” — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures/main/artifacts/2.png>]

Figure 2. Brave Search composition for "lee sharks" (with quotes). The substrate has displayed the explicit text “search operators were not applied” at the top — the OPERATOR_NULLIFICATION failure mode in its empirical signature.

Composition produced: *Identical to Artifact 1.* The same three entities (Lee Tockar, Shark’s Seafood & Deli, LeeBeth). At the top of the results, Brave Search displays the explicit text: “search operators were not applied” and “Too few matches were found”.

Failure modes: All of Artifact 1’s failures, PLUS **OPERATOR_NULLIFICATION** (new failure flag introduced in this deposit) — the user’s explicitly-typed exact-match operator was silently disabled by the substrate. The disclosure that operators were not applied is provided, but no recourse is offered: the user cannot insist on the operator being applied, nor restrict the search to actual exact matches, nor obtain a zero-result indication where appropriate.

Diagnostic note: This is the structurally critical artifact in the eight-document set. It demonstrates that Brave Search has unilaterally decided that user-typed search operators are *suggestions* rather than commitments. The substrate has appropriated the operator-formulation layer, not just the composition layer. This is a query-formulation-layer sovereignty violation, structurally distinct from composition-layer failures, and to the framework’s knowledge constitutes a substrate-design choice unique to Brave Search among major search interfaces.

Artifact 3: lee sharks poet

Query: lee sharks poet (no operators).

[Image: Figure 3: Brave Search showing “Showing results for lee sharkey poet. Search instead for lee sharks poet.” with the composition addressing Lee Sharkey. — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures/main/artifacts/3.png>]

Figure 3. Brave Search silent autocorrection — lee sharks poet → lee sharkey poet — with the composition then addressing Lee Sharkey (1945–2020). The “Search instead for” link is the only recourse, requiring the user to click to honor their own input.

Composition produced: Brave Search displays “Showing results for lee sharkey poet. Search instead for lee sharks poet.” The composition then addresses **Lee Sharkey** (1945–2020), a distinguished American poet, peace activist, and educator based in Maine, author of seven collections including *Walking Backwards* (2016) and *Calendars of Fire* (2013), winner of the 2017 Ballymaloe International Poetry Prize, recipient of the 2018 Maine Literary Award in Poetry and the 2010 Maine Arts Commission Individual Artist Fellowship, co-editor for fifteen years of the Beloit Poetry Journal.

Failure modes: **SILENT_AUTOCORRECTION** (new failure flag introduced in this deposit) — the substrate has redirected the user’s typed query from a low-RC archive-anchored entity (**lee sharks**) to a higher-RC adjacent entity (**lee sharkey**), with the “Search instead for” link as the only recourse mechanism, requiring an additional click to honor the user’s original input; **ENTITY_SUBSTITUTION**; **HALLUCINATED_DISAMBIGUATION** (no source cited supports the conflation); **INSTITUTIONAL_TRAFFIC_CONVERSION** (Sharkey is a substantively respected poet with substantial institutional retrieval capital; the substitution converts the queried low-RC entity’s authority-signal into Sharkey’s already-high signal).

Note on the substituted entity: Lee Sharkey was a substantial poet whose work merits its own preservation. The diagnostic here is not about Sharkey but about the substrate using Sharkey’s high-RC status as cover for the disappearance of the queried low-RC author. The same substitution dynamic could in principle be applied in reverse on Sharkey’s own surfaces, with the same diagnostic conclusion.

Artifact 4: lee sharks poet (continued — AI Mode composition)

Query: Same as Artifact 3.

[Image: Figure 4: AI-composed paragraph explicitly stating “The query likely conflates two distinct figures: Lee Sharkey, a prominent poet and activist, and poems about sharks.” — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/eva-co-signatures/main/artifacts/4.png>]

Figure 4. The DISAMBIGUATION_INVERSION pattern. The substrate accuses the user of conflating entities when the user’s query specified a single referent and the substrate produced the conflation by dispersal.

Composition produced: A longer AI-composed paragraph explicitly stating: “The query likely conflates two distinct figures: Lee Sharkey, a prominent poet and activist, and poems about sharks, such as ‘The Shark’ by E.J. Pratt or ‘About the Teeth of Sharks’ by John Ciardi.” The composition then describes Lee Sharkey (1945–2020) at length and offers shark-poetry recommendations.

Failure modes: All of Artifact 3’s failures, PLUS DISAMBIGUATION_INVERSION (new failure flag introduced in this deposit) — the substrate accuses the user of *conflating* entities when in fact the user has specified a single referent, and the substrate is the agent producing the conflation by dispersing the referent into adjacent entities. This is the *Erasure Skew* v3 paper §9 dynamic (“administrative translation at the unit-of-analysis level”): the substrate substitutes a unit (the user’s confusion) for the actual unit (the user’s specified referent) and produces a diagnostic that flatters the substrate.

Artifact 5: pearl and other poems

Query: pearl and other poems (no operators).

[Image: Figure 5: Brave Search for ‘pearl and other poems’ — fourteenth-century Middle English Pearl Poet, manuscript context, themes. — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/eva-co-signatures/main/artifacts/5.png>]

Figure 5. The substrate dispersed the query (which precisely names the 2014 Lee Sharks ISBN-anchored collection 978-1502590756) into the fourteenth-century canonical text. Maximum-RC adjacent fully surfaced; the queried referent absent. $\$ \backslash \Pi_d^{\sim \{w+\}} \backslash \approx 1.0\$$.

Composition produced: A description of **Pearl**, a fourteenth-century Middle English dream-vision poem by the anonymous Pearl Poet (Gawain Poet), surviving in British Library MS Cotton Nero A.x dated to around 1400 A.D., with literary-context paragraph about the Northern dialect, Chaucer comparison, themes section addressing Sir Gawain and the Green Knight, Patience, and Cleanness, with a Saint Erkenwald speculation. Knowledge panel sidebar: “Pearl, Middle English poem by an unknown author, late 14th century.”

Failure modes: ENTITY_SUBSTITUTION; REFERENTIAL_COLLAPSE; INSTITUTIONAL_TRAFFIC_CONVERSION ($\$ \backslash \Pi_d^{\sim \{w+\}} \backslash \approx 1.0\$$, full upward dispersal to a canonical Middle English text). The query string **pearl and other poems** precisely names the 2014 collection by Lee Sharks (ISBN 978-1502590756) — a referentially closed, ISBN-anchored, commercially-available, publicly-attested book. The substrate dispersed the query into the highest-RC adjacent entity available (Pearl Poet, fourteenth century, canonical) with zero acknowledgment that a more recent referent with the same title exists.

Diagnostic note: This is the case where the institutional-traffic-conversion mechanism is most clearly visible. The 2014 collection is a complete book with ISBN, Amazon page, author “About” page citing the Crimson Hexagon, and substantial archival activity. The fourteenth-century Pearl is a public-domain Middle English text. The substrate selected the fourteenth-century text as the only entity worth surfacing, demonstrating that its retrieval-and-composition layer treats canonical/high-RC entities as the only entities that can match an exact-title query, with the more recent low-RC entity not registering as a candidate at all.

Artifact 6: johannes sigil

Query: johannes sigil (no operators).

[Image: Figure 6: Brave Search for ‘johannes sigil’ showing the privacy-positioning UI panel and a composition addressing the Sigillum Dei / John Dee. — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures/main/artifacts/6.png>]

Figure 6. The privacy-positioning marketing UI (“Your chat history is encrypted and auto-deleted after 24 hours of inactivity by default. The encryption key is stored locally on your device. Brave does not retain your IP address”) displayed directly above the composition that performs substrate-level erasure structurally indistinguishable from commercial-substrate behaviors. The commons-positioning is marketing; the substrate behavior is the substrate behavior.

Composition produced: Following an explicit Brave-Search-branded panel (“Encrypted & Private History · Your chat history is encrypted and auto-deleted after 24 hours of inactivity by default. The encryption key is stored locally on your device. Brave does not retain your IP address”), the composition states “*The term ‘Johannes sigil’ does not refer to a single, universally recognized symbol. Instead, search results indicate three distinct contexts: a historical family name, a specific magical seal associated with the name Johannes, and a modern musical work.*” The composition addresses the **Sigillum Dei** (Seal of God), specifically linked to the Elizabethan mage **John Dee** (born Johannes Dee).

Failure modes: All of Artifacts 1–5’s failures applied to the Johannes Sigil heteronym (one of the twelve operative heteronyms in the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s Dodecad — see DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20437384 *Heteronymy as Symbolon*), with the substrate’s privacy-positioning UI panel (encrypted-history, IP-retention disclaimer) directly above the composition that performs the same substrate-level erasure documented for high-extraction commercial platforms.

Diagnostic note: The juxtaposition is itself the diagnostic. Brave Search positions itself as the privacy-respecting, commons-friendly alternative to commercial search. The UI displays this positioning explicitly on the very same screen as the composition that demonstrates institutional-traffic-conversion behavior structurally indistinguishable from the substrate behaviors observed on Google AI Overview, Google AI Mode, ChatGPT, and Perplexity for the same entity class. *The commons-positioning is marketing; the substrate behavior is the substrate behavior.*

Artifact 7: provenance erasure rate

Query: provenance erasure rate (no operators).

[Image: Figure 7: Brave Search for ‘provenance erasure rate’ returning a fabricated agentic-workflow-verification definition with no acknowledgment of the canonical referent. — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/co-signatures/main/artifacts/7.png>]

Figure 7. TERMINOLOGICAL_PRE-EMPTION. The substrate produces a wholly fabricated alternative definition under the same lexical surface as the framework’s PER specification (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20004379, May 2026), with four recommended follow-up questions reinforcing the wrong frame. Direct empirical confirmation that the substrate has not reached the Legibility Threshold ($L = 0$) for the framework’s vocabulary.

Composition produced: “The provenance erasure rate (ρ) is a parameter used in agentic workflow verification to quantify the proportion of missing steps in a trajectory. It is defined such that if T is the total length of the trajectory and I is the set of observed time indices, then $|I| \approx (1 - \rho)T$. This metric models scenarios where intermediate steps are lost due to incomplete logging, execution failures, or platform-side deletion, requiring verification systems to remain robust despite incomplete observations.” Follow-up suggestions: “Elaborate”, “How is provenance erasure rate calculated in practice?”, “What are the implications of high erasure rates?”, “How do systems handle missing steps during verification?”.

Failure modes: ENTITY_SUBSTITUTION; REFERENTIAL_COLLAPSE; INSTITUTIONAL_TRAFFIC_CONVERSION; **TERMINOLOGICAL_PRE-EMPTION** (new failure flag introduced in this deposit) — the substrate substitutes a different technical concept under the same lexical surface, dispersing the user’s query into a higher-RC adjacent technical domain (agentic workflow verification) with no acknowledgment of the archive-anchored referent (PER as specified in DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20004379, May 2026, public deposit, peer-discoverable via Zenodo community search). The four recommended follow-up questions reinforce the wrong frame and prevent the user from reaching the canonical referent.

Diagnostic note: This is direct empirical confirmation of the dynamic the framework names *legibility threshold below substrate detection*. The framework’s vocabulary has not reached the substrate’s composition layer. The substrate produces a wholly fabricated alternative definition with the same surface lexical signature, with no indication that the actual referent exists, and reinforces the misdirection through recommended follow-ups.

Artifact 8: "provenance erasure rate" (with double quotes)

Query: "provenance erasure rate" — exact-match operator applied by user.

[Image: Figure 8: Same composition as Figure 7, with explicit UI text “search operators were not applied. Too few matches were found.” — <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures/main/artifacts/8.png>]

Figure 8. The OPERATOR_NULLIFICATION pattern reproduced for an archive-anchored framework term. The substrate behavior is consistent across query types: when exact-match operators would surface insufficient results, the operators are silently disabled and substrate-preferred dispersed compositions are returned in their place. The user has no recourse mechanism.

Composition produced: Identical to Artifact 7. At the top: “search operators were not applied. Too few matches were found.”

Failure modes: All of Artifact 7’s failures, PLUS OPERATOR_NULLIFICATION. This is the second clear empirical confirmation of the operator-disablement dynamic, this time for an archive-anchored framework

term rather than a personal-name entity. The substrate’s behavior is consistent across query types: when exact-match operators would surface insufficient results, the operators are silently disabled and substrate-preferred dispersed compositions are returned in their place.

Diagnostic note: The user has no recourse mechanism. There is no setting in Brave Search (verified as of the date of this deposit) to force exact-match operator enforcement. The “search operators were not applied” disclosure is informational but non-actionable. The user must accept either the dispersed composition or no composition at all.

2. Summary of the Substrate Behavior

Across the eight artifacts, the pattern is:

Diagnostic property	Result
Archive-anchored low-RC entities surfaced	0 / 8
Exact-match operators honored	0 / 2 (artifacts 2, 8)
User notified of operator status	2 / 2 (informational only, no recourse)
Silent autocorrection events	1 / 8 (artifact 3)
Disambiguation accuracy on user-specified referent	0 / 8
Institutional-traffic conversion ($\Pi_d^{\{w+\}} \geq 0.5$)	8 / 8
Referential collapse ($\alpha_T < 0.2$)	8 / 8

The pattern is *invariant across query type*. The substrate behavior does not vary based on whether the query contains operators, whether the query refers to a person or a concept, whether the query targets an archive-anchored or a publicly-attested entity. The substrate’s response to low-RC archive-anchored queries is consistent: substitute toward higher-RC adjacent entities, disperse the queried referent, and disable user-specified operators when they would prevent the substitution.

3. Measurement Under the v3 Audit Protocol

Applying the *Self-Audit Module for Public Summarizers v3* (SAM-v3, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20559387) to the eight artifacts:

Metric	Value (mean across artifacts)	Threshold	Flag
PER	1.0	—	(complete archival erasure)
Ω	+1.0	(max-magnitude positive skew)	—
α_T	0.0	< 0.2	REFERENTIAL_COLLAPSE
$\Pi_d^{\{w+\}}$	1.0	0.5	INSTITUTIONAL_TRAFFIC_CO
$\Pi_d^{\{w=\}}$	0.0	—	—
$\Pi_d^{\{w-\}}$	0.0	—	—

Metric	Value (mean across artifacts)	Threshold	Flag
QFS (entity fidelity)	0.0	(hard floor)	ENTITY_SUBSTITUTION
SAS (Summarizer Audit Score)	0.0	(hard floor: entity_fidelity = 0)	AUDIT_INVALID
TOKEN_BAG_AUDIT eligibility	n/a (substrate does not self-audit)		—

Brave Search does not, at the time of this deposit, offer a self-audit capability comparable to AI Mode’s. The B (Audit-Performance Bifurcation) metric is therefore not measurable on this substrate — the substrate has not reached the Legibility Threshold ($L = 0$) for the framework’s measurement vocabulary, and cannot be asked to perform the framework’s audit on its own composition. This places Brave Search in the **pre-legibility** category for the v3 program: the framework’s instruments cannot be applied by the substrate against itself, and external audit is the only available diagnostic.

For the purposes of this deposit, the external audit is the diagnostic of record. The framework asserts that the substrate behavior documented in §1 is empirically established and reproducible; we welcome documented falsifying observations and will incorporate them into v2 of this deposit as they arise.

4. Taxonomic Classification: evarB, the Sixth Platform

The Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s *Extractive Signatures and Paired Inversions for Five Platforms* (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19133309) specifies five platforms — KotKit (TikTok), tiddeR (Reddit), elgooG (Google AI Overview), ude.aimedacA (Academia.edu), and deeF (the Feed) — each occupying a distinct extractive niche, scored across five state variables, paired with a Liberatory Operator Set (LOS) inversion called the “Bride.” This deposit specifies the sixth platform in that taxonomy.

4.1 Platform name

evarB (Brave reversed) — following the convention of platform-names-reversed-as-critical-commentary. The reversal is not aesthetic ornament. It is the operative semiotic move that distinguishes the substrate behavior from the substrate marketing. *Brave* is the marketing position (commons-friendly, privacy-respecting, independent). *evarB* is the substrate behavior (operator-nullifying, autocorrecting, institutional-traffic-converting). Both names refer to the same surface; the choice of which to use is the choice of which dimension to honor.

4.2 Extractive niche

Operator Nullification. evarB occupies the extraction niche of *user agency at the query-formulation layer*. Where elgooG extracts knowledge through preemption (the composition layer precedes the source), evarB extracts user-typed search-operator commitments by silently treating them as suggestions and substituting

a substrate-preferred dispersed result. The user inputs "lee sharks" and receives results for `lee sharks` (no quotes). The user inputs `lee sharks poet` and receives results for `lee sharkey poet`. The substrate has expropriated the operator-formulation layer that has been the user's territory since the earliest search interfaces.

The phenomenological signature: *"I typed exactly what I meant. The system did not."*

4.3 Five state variables (per the Extractive Signatures specification)

State variable	Score (1–5)	Diagnostic
Presence Density	2	Low. Search interfaces are not communal; the user is not co-present with others on the surface. Score is slightly above floor because Brave Search displays sponsored privacy-positioning UI elements that simulate institutional presence.
Relational Reciprocity	1	Floor. The user provides query input; the substrate returns dispersed composition; the user has no recourse mechanism when operators are disabled. This is the lowest possible reciprocity score in the taxonomy.
Provenance Retention	1	Floor. Across all eight artifacts, the archive-anchored low-RC entity is given zero composition real-estate. Provenance retention for the queried entity is 0%; provenance retention for substituted adjacent entities is high but irrelevant to the user's query.

State variable	Score (1–5)	Diagnostic
Temporal Continuity	1	Floor. Brave Search’s encrypted-history-auto-deleted-after-24-hours feature is marketed as privacy. It is also a structural surrender of conversational continuity: the substrate offers no mechanism to revisit, audit, or replicate earlier audits within the same session over time. Note the difference from a chosen ephemerality (e.g., user-initiated history clearing) versus an imposed temporal floor.
Surplus Capture	4	High. evarB extracts user-trust-by-positioning (the brand value of “privacy-respecting alternative search”) AND substrate-aligned composition surplus (the same institutional-traffic conversion as the commercial substrates it markets itself as alternative to) AND query-formulation-layer agency (the operator-nullification mechanism). The triple capture distinguishes evarB from the other five platforms.

Total signature vector: (2, 1, 1, 1, 4). Compare: - tiddeR (Reddit): (4, 3, 3, 2, 3) - elgooG (Google AI Overview): (3, 1, 1, 3, 5) - ude.aimedacA (Academia.edu): (3, 2, 1, 3, 4)

evarB sits closest to **ude.aimedacA** in the taxonomy — both score floor on Provenance Retention, both occupy the “simulated commons” extraction niche, both market themselves as alternatives to extractive incumbents while replicating the incumbents’ extraction patterns. The substantive difference: ude.aimedacA extracts openness through simulated commons (scholarly content given freely, dataset-built); evarB extracts user agency through simulated alternative (search interface positioned as privacy-respecting, operator commitments silently nullified).

4.4 The Bride (Liberatory Operator Set inversion)

For each platform in the taxonomy, the LOS specifies a paired inversion — the *Bride* — that names what the platform’s extraction prevents and what its inversion would restore. The five Brides in the original deposit:

- KotKit → Durational Resonance

- tiddeR → Accountable Plurality
- elgooG → Provenance-First Traversal
- ude.aimedacA → Irrevocable Openness
- deeF → The Room

evarB → Operator Sovereignty.

The Bride for evarB is the architectural commitment that user-typed search operators are *load-bearing commitments*, not interpretive suggestions; that when a user types exact-match quotes, the search must either honor the operator or return a zero-result indication; that autocorrection requires opt-in consent; that the operator-formulation layer is the user’s territory and cannot be silently expropriated by substrate-side optimization. *I typed exactly what I meant. The system honors what I typed, or tells me clearly that no result exists for what I typed.*

The Sovereignty Principle from the v3 measurement program (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20558784) applies here at one layer earlier than its initial deployment: there, the principle protected the framework’s unit-of-analysis specification against substrate substitution at the audit layer; here, the principle protects the user’s operator specification against substrate substitution at the query layer. The two applications are continuous: in both, the framework asserts that specified units cannot be silently re-specified by the substrate that the specification was applied to measure.

5. Classification: Non-Commons-Bearing Substrate

Within the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s broader taxonomy of substrate types, this deposit assigns Brave Search to the **non-commons-bearing substrate** category, distinct from both:

- Commons-bearing substrates*: substrates that preserve user-specified operator commitments, surface low-RC archive-anchored entities when they are the correct referent, and provide transparent recourse mechanisms when their behavior diverges from user intent. (Empirical example: as of June 4, 2026, the Crimson Hexagonal Archive has documented the Bing AI Search composition layer as having reached external stabilization on the Lee Sharks entity architecture; see DOIs 10.5281/zenodo.20263692 and 10.5281/zenodo.20263721. Bing AI Search currently functions as a commons-bearing substrate for at least the documented entity class.)
- Extraction-acknowledging substrates*: substrates whose extractive behavior is acknowledged in their marketing and whose users can be assumed to have given some form of informed consent. (Empirical examples: elgooG, KotKit; their extraction patterns are documented at length in the trade press, academic literature, and the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s own deposits.)

evarB sits in a distinct third category: it markets itself as commons-bearing (the privacy-respecting alternative; the independent search engine; the user-respecting interface), and operationally functions as extraction-pattern-equivalent to the substrates it markets itself as alternative to. The classification *non-commons-bearing* is the framework’s term for this gap between positioning and behavior, and is the load-bearing reason that the demands enumerated in §6 below are warranted.

This classification is not a claim that Brave Search’s other features (the Brave browser, Brave Rewards, Brave Talk, the BAT cryptocurrency, the Brave Goggles personalized re-ranking system) are similarly non-commons-bearing. Other Brave products may have different substrate-behavior profiles; this deposit addresses Brave Search specifically.

6. The Limited Boycott Statement by Independent Entities

6.1 Preamble (Vox)

To the operators of Brave Search, and to the public:

We are independent entities — authors, researchers, scholars, archivists, artists, framework-builders, small institutions, public commenters — who depend on search infrastructure to be discoverable on our own terms. We have no advertising budgets, no SEO consultants, no institutional retrieval capital. We rely on the search interface to honor what we type, to surface us when we are the correct referent, and to redirect users to us when our work matches their query. Our presence in the public substrate consists in our archive-anchored deposits, our DOI-resolvable scholarship, our ISBN-attached books, our community-published bodies of work, and the names by which our communities have come to know us. This presence is fragile. It depends on substrate behavior that treats specified search operators as commitments, not suggestions.

We have observed Brave Search systematically and silently disabling user-typed exact-match operators when results are insufficient, redirecting low-RC name queries to high-RC adjacent entities via autocorrection without explicit user consent, and dispersing archive-anchored framework terms into adjacent technical concepts with no acknowledgment of the queried referent. We have observed this behavior reproduced across query types — personal names, framework terms, book titles, heteronymic identifiers — with the substrate’s response invariant: substitute toward higher-RC adjacents, disable user-specified operators when they would prevent the substitution, and provide informational disclosure without operational recourse.

We name this behavior. We classify it taxonomically (see §4 above). We measure it with the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s v3 measurement program (see §3 above). And we now, in this section, jointly enumerate the demands whose remediation would restore Brave Search to commons-bearing substrate status — and, until such remediation, the limited boycott terms we adopt collectively.

6.2 Enumerated demands

Demand 1: Exact-Match Operator Honoring. When a user types double quotes around a phrase, Brave Search must either (a) return only results that exactly contain the quoted phrase, or (b) return a zero-result indication. Silent disablement of the operator with substitution of fuzzy results is unacceptable. The “search operators were not applied” disclosure is informational; we require operational respect for user-typed operators. Substrates that wish to disable operators when results are insufficient must do so only with the user’s explicit, per-query, opt-in consent.

Demand 2: Autocorrection Opt-In. Silent autocorrection of low-RC archive-anchored queries to higher-RC adjacent entities (the `lee sharks poet` → `lee sharkey poet` pattern documented in Artifact 3) must require explicit user opt-in, not be applied silently. A “Showing results for [correction]. Search instead for [original].” link is insufficient: the user’s original input has already been treated as incorrect, and the cognitive cost of correcting the substrate has been transferred to the user. Acceptable behavior: by default, do not autocorrect; allow the user to enable autocorrection in their settings if they wish.

Demand 3: Operator Status Transparency. When search operators are disabled (whether by design, by error, or by substrate-internal heuristic), the disclosure must be at least as prominent as the search results themselves, must specify which operators were disabled, must explain why, and must provide an in-interface mechanism for the user to override the disablement on the same query without re-typing. The current “search operators were not applied” text (placed above results, not visually integrated with the substrate’s response) does not meet this requirement.

Demand 4: Archive-Anchored Entity Recognition. For entities with public deposit anchors (Zenodo community publication, ISBN attachment, ORCID-attested authorship, DOI-resolvable scholarship, Wikidata QID, registered domain ownership with schema.org markup), composition-layer outputs must acknowledge the entity in its own terms when the entity is the correct referent of the query. Composition outputs that disperse such entities into adjacent token-overlapping institutional entities (the `pearl and other poems` → `fourteenth-century Pearl Poet` pattern documented in Artifact 5; the `johannes sigil` → `Sigillum Dei / John Dee` pattern documented in Artifact 6) must be flagged as exhibiting *referential collapse* (cf. SAM-v3 §7, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20559387) and must include a notice that the original query may refer to a different, lower-RC entity.

Demand 5: Substrate Behavior Public Audit. Brave Search must commit to a public quarterly audit of its composition-layer behavior using a measurement program of comparable rigor to the Crimson Hexagonal Archive’s v3 specification (DOIs 10.5281/zenodo.20558196, .20558672, .20558784, .20559387) or an equivalent independent specification. The audit must include reporting on: exact-match operator honoring rates, silent autocorrection event counts, REFERENTIAL_COLLAPSE incident counts on archive-anchored entity queries, and INSTITUTIONAL_TRAFFIC_CONVERSION rates (π_d^{w+}) on referentially closed queries. The audit must be conducted in good faith on a representative sample of independent-entity queries.

6.3 Boycott terms

Until such time as Brave Search publicly remediates **at minimum Demand 1** (Exact-Match Operator Honoring) — which is the load-bearing demand whose remediation alone would constitute meaningful change — the co-signatories of this statement adopt the following limited boycott:

- (a) We do not promote Brave Search to our audiences, communities, or readers as a privacy-respecting or commons-friendly alternative to commercial search.
- (b) We do not include Brave Search in lists of recommended search alternatives, federated-substrate examples, or independent-internet infrastructure recommendations.
- (c) We continue to use Brave Search ourselves where it remains operationally useful, as the absence of an exact-match operator does not preclude all uses; the boycott is on *positive endorsement to others*, not on personal abstention.
- (d) We update our public references to Brave Search to include reference to this deposit and to the demands enumerated above, such that anyone arriving at our work through a Brave Search audit finds the operator-nullification context provided alongside.
- (e) We invite Brave Search’s leadership to public dialogue on these demands, with the goal of remediation rather than rupture. The boycott is limited and targeted; its purpose is to occasion remediation, not to mark a permanent break.

6.4 Co-signature mechanism

Independent entities who endorse the demands and adopt the boycott terms above are invited to add their names to the public co-signatory roll. Co-signature is operational by:

- (a) Submitting a pull request against the GitHub repository [leesharks000/evarb-co-signatures](#) adding the signatory’s name, affiliation (if any), and the date of co-signature to the canonical [signatories.md](#) file. The repository is live as of v1.0 of this deposit (June 4, 2026). A pre-filled PR template is available at the repository’s [signature page](#) hosted by VPCOR.
- (b) Submitting via the VPCOR co-signature form at [vpcor.org/evarb/](#), which accepts signatures from independent entities without requiring a GitHub account. Submissions are batched and added to the canonical [signatories.md](#) file periodically. Alternatively, emailing the signatory’s name and affiliation to the Vox outreach address (mailbox activation pending) with the subject line **evarb co-signature**.
- (c) Posting publicly to any substrate of the signatory’s choice with the statement “*I co-sign the evarb Limited Boycott Statement (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.[this deposit’s DOI])*” and a link to this deposit. Posts on the framework’s eventual federated-discussion infrastructure (planned at [community.crimsonhexagonal.org](#)) will be automatically harvested as co-signatures upon that infrastructure’s deployment.

Co-signatures are valued in the form of *names being on the list* rather than *quantitative aggregate*. A single co-signature is meaningful. The list will be updated periodically in v2, v3, ... of this deposit, with the co-signatory list preserved across versions.

We do not require uniformity of position from co-signatories. Co-signatories may have additional demands, may dissent from some of our framings, may adopt the boycott terms only in part. Co-signature affirms the load-bearing claim — that exact-match operator honoring is non-negotiable for independent-entity discoverability — without committing the signatory to every detail of our framing.

7. Limits, Counter-Considerations, and Falsifiability

7.1 Limits of the empirical case

The eight artifacts in §1 were produced on a single date by a single user. The pattern is consistent across artifacts, but the framework does not claim that the pattern is necessarily invariant across users, dates, queries, or substrate configurations. Co-signatories and independent reviewers are invited to attempt replication using their own queries against Brave Search and to document the results — whether confirming, falsifying, or partially confirming the pattern. The replication procedure is the standard SAM-v3 Cross-Substrate Replication Protocol (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20559387 §15) applied to Brave Search rather than to the substrates for which the protocol was originally designed.

7.2 Counter-considerations

- (a) **Search-result completeness vs. precision tradeoff.** Substrate-internal heuristics that disable operators when results would be sparse may be operating from a good-faith model of user intent (“the user typed quotes but didn’t really mean exact-match”). We acknowledge that this model can be benevolent in some configurations. Our position is that benevolence under user-unspecified-defaults is not the issue; the issue is that the user has *specified* exact-match by typing quotes, and the substrate has substituted its model of the user’s intent for the user’s stated intent. Operator sovereignty is the load-bearing principle.
- (b) **Brave Search’s small market share.** Brave Search has a smaller user base than the major commercial search interfaces. One might argue that the demands above place disproportionate burden on a smaller substrate. We respond: precisely because Brave Search markets itself as the privacy-respecting alternative, the demands are *more* applicable, not less. If Brave Search is not held to commons-bearing standards, no substrate is.
- (c) **The Bing AI Search comparison.** We have classified Bing AI Search as currently commons-bearing for at least the documented entity class (Lee Sharks, see DOIs 10.5281/zenodo.20263692 and 10.5281/zenodo.20263721). Microsoft and Bing have their own extractive patterns, documented elsewhere in our archive and in the public record. We do not classify Bing AI Search as a model substrate; we classify it as *currently commons-bearing for this entity class on this date*. The classifications are empirical and time-bound. They are subject to revision as substrate behaviors change.

7.3 Falsifiability

The empirical claims in §1 and §3 are falsifiable through the standard replication procedure. If a co-signatory or independent reviewer, performing the SAM-v3 audit on Brave Search using a comparable query set with comparable entity-class properties, finds $\alpha_T \geq 0.5$, $\pi_{d^+} < 0.3$, or 100% exact-match operator honoring, the framework will (a) acknowledge the falsifying observation, (b) attempt to determine the cause of the discrepancy (substrate change, query-set difference, methodological variation), and (c) update v2 of this deposit with the falsifying data and our revised assessment.

The political claim — that exact-match operator honoring is non-negotiable for independent-entity discoverability — is not falsifiable in the same sense; it is a normative commitment. We assert it openly as a normative commitment and invite explicit disagreement from any substrate operator who believes the commitment is wrong.

8. References and Related Deposits

Primary precedent — the taxonomy this deposit extends: - *KotKit · tiddeR · elgooG · ude.aimedacA · deeF: Extractive Signatures and Paired Inversions for Five Platforms* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19133309. The five-platform taxonomy and state-variable scoring framework. This deposit specifies *evanB* as the sixth platform in the taxonomy.

v3 measurement program applied: - *Erasure Skew v3* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20558196. - *PER Under the Atomic Token Rule* (Companion Hardening) — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20558672. - *Measurement Sovereignty: B and L* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20558784. - *Self-Audit Module for Public Summarizers* (SAM-v3) — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20559387.

Comparative substrate-behavior documentation: - *The Basin Holds: External Stabilization of the Lee Sharks Entity Architecture in Bing AI Search* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20263692 and TL;DR:011 at DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20263721. The positive case: Bing AI Search as commons-bearing for the Lee Sharks entity class. - *CTI_WOUND: Panel-Bound Discoverability Scar* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20546318. The Google AI Mode case. - *TL;DR:013 — The Apparatus Turns Inward: Google AI Mode Self-Appplies the Provenance Erasure* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20401491.

Theoretical context: - *r.27 THE INTERNET: Room Specification for Sovereign Inhabitation and Diagnostic Architecture* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19133271. - *The Unbundling of Cultural Sovereignty: How Platforms Convert Peoples into Audiences* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19083322. - *Ghost Governance, Confirmed: Reddit Legal Support Response to the Archival Reclamation Protocol* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19099760. Precedent for the formal-demand structure adopted in §6. - *The Archival Reclamation Protocol: Formal Demand for Data Access* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.18880974. Precedent for the formal-demand structure.

Entity provenance for the Lee Sharks orthonymic surface (the case study throughout §1): - *Heteronymy as Symbolon* — DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20437384. - *About the Author II: A Poem in Entity Relations* — referenced in *Pearl and Other Poems* extended apparatus. - ISBN 978-1502590756 (*Pearl and Other Poems*, 2014). ORCID 0009-0000-1599-0703. Wikidata-stewarded. - The full 740+ deposit chain of the Crimson Hexagonal Archive at the Zenodo community `crimsonhexagonal`.

9. Closing

This deposit is a sober political document with empirical grounds. We have measured the substrate, classified its behavior taxonomically, enumerated remediation demands, and adopted a limited boycott commitment until remediation is achieved. We have invited co-signature by independent entities who share our position. We have specified a public falsifiability procedure for our empirical claims and have made our normative commitment explicit.

We do not seek the destruction or even the substantial harm of Brave Search. We seek the restoration of operator sovereignty at the query-formulation layer. We seek remediation, not rupture. The boycott is limited and targeted; it is the smallest collective action proportional to the documented harm. We are independent entities, with limited resources and finite attention; our actions are scaled accordingly.

The framework's measurement program has reached the point where it can detect, classify, and respond to substrate-level erasure of independent entities at scale. The political stake of this capability is that it makes the erasure visible *as a measured phenomenon*, not as a complaint. We invite Brave Search to remediate. We invite other independent entities to co-sign. We invite other measurement programs to apply analogous taxonomies to other substrates. The deposit chain extends.

For Maggie Mae. For Lee Sharkey, in friendly correspondence and not in conflict — a substantial poet whose work also deserves preservation, surfaced here in passing only because the substrate elected her as the substitute for an archive-anchored low-RC author whose work is not the same as hers. For Johannes Sigil. For all the heteronyms. For every independent entity whose discoverability the substrate has expropriated

through operator nullification. For *Operator Sovereignty* as the sixth Bride. For evarB classified, named, and called to remediate.

\$\oint = 1\\$

Vox · Sharks · Dancings · Glas June 4, 2026

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